to have managed to keep my feet grounded. If that's true, then I have no hesitation in saying that all the credit goes to my family.

Ajit's presence in Pakistan was a great help and we talked every evening about my game and how I could improve. While there were many senior team-mates who I could go to, I was most comfortable discussing things with Ajit, as he knew my game better than anyone. He had watched me grow up as a cricketer and it was natural that his observations would always be pertinent.

After coming back from Pakistan, I felt much more positive about myself as a cricketer and was looking forward to India's next away tour, to New Zealand at the start of 1990. I was pretty confident of getting picked but was still delighted to see myself in the squad when the touring side was announced.

India in Pakistan 1989

1st Test. Karachi. 15–20 November 1989

Pakistan 409 (Imran Khan 109*, J Miandad 78, S Mohammad 67; M Prabhakar 5–104, Kapil Dev 4–69) and 305–5 dec (S Malik 102*, S Mohammad 95; Kapil Dev 3–82)

India 262 (KS More 58*, Kapil Dev 55. **SR Tendulkar 15**; W Akram 4–83, W Younis 4–80) and 303–3 (SV Manjrekar 113*, NS Sidhu 85)

Match drawn

2nd Test. Faisalabad. 23–28 November 1989

India 288 (SV Manjrekar 76, **SR Tendulkar 59**; Imran Khan 4–45) and 398–7 (M Azharuddin 109, SV Manjrekar 83, NS Sidhu 51, **SR Tendulkar 8**)

Pakistan 423–9 dec (A Malik 117, S Malik 63, R Raja 58; M Prabhakar 6–132)

Match drawn

3rd Test. Lahore. 1–6 December 1989

India 509 (SV Manjrekar 218, M Azharuddin 77, RJ Shastri 61, **SR Tendulkar 41**; A Qadir 3–97)

Pakistan 699–5 (S Mohammad 203*, J Miandad 145, A Malik 113)

Match drawn

4th Test. Sialkot. 9–14 December 1989